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Culture (OWC): [Tonga \(FQ12\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

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Place Coverage: Eastern Southern Province, Zambia

Section Title(S)

Inter-neighbourhood Activities • Internal Organization of the Neighbourhood

In return for their services, the *basilufulo* who served during the funeral have a right to receive small gifts from the estate of the dead. They are summoned for offerings and should receive a special allotment of beer.

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If the *silufulo* lineage feels itself aggrieved, it can refuse to perform its obligations until it receives satisfaction; but since it too depends upon its partner in its own need, there is every reason for the two lineages to come to quick agreement.

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It may be that the *silufulo* arrangement grew up to bring together strong Upper River lineages which as a result of the practice of marrying slave women had become largely independent of the need to rely upon those outside the lineage for ritual services. Since children were now members of their fathers' lineage, *matundu* and lineage tended to become one. The *silufulo* arrangement brings the lineage back into dependence upon others resident in the community, though these are members of its own clan. Upper River people say that the man or woman whose kinship ties are confined within one lineage is at a disadvantage. He ought to have some strong link with other people. The *silufulo* arrangement provides for the intrusion of those who are officially neutrals into the affairs of the lineage and thus helps to protect its individual

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members. At the same time the lineage has an ally who can mediate between it and others in the community.

Inter-neighbourhood Activities

Each neighbourhood takes its place within a vicinage of neighbourhoods. Frequently the members meet as individuals, and then they regulate their relationships in terms of clan membership, kinship and, in the Middle River and Upland regions, clan joking-relationships. But on occasion, neighbourhoods face one another as discrete units.

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Community Structure

The Drums. This takes place most often at funerals when Drum teams of a number of neighbourhoods appear together. Each team is composed of young married men and youths with an accompanying chorus of girls. The team does not have an official head, but several young men provide an informal leadership. 182 Older members of the neighbourhood occasionally dance with the Drum, especially when it performs on its home ground, and a few elders usually accompany it even on distant expeditions.

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